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Rose

December 1943

After returning from Berlin, Rose discovered that Reinhardt was out of town. The first night she delivered the sick bay reports to the Gestapo office, it was Frau Birks—the one who always made tea on Reinhardt's orders—who opened the door.

"Herr Reinhardt is away," she said, lifting her shoulders and extending her arm. "You may leave the report with me."

For the entire week, Frau Birks again opened the door.

Rose wanted to know how long he would be away. She worried about André and his safety. A transfer would take months, and from what she could read of the headlines in the German papers, the Allies had intensified their bombing campaign.

The second week, Rose finally mustered the resolve to speak to Frau Birks. "When will Herr Reinhardt return?"

She snapped the file from Rose's hand. "Missing your lover?"

Rose bristled. "I don't understand."

"I know why he sends me home after you arrive." Her voice was husky and rough like a smoker's. "The whole town is talking about it."

"If that is the case, and I don't believe it is, they're only repeating the malicious gossip you spread about the man you work for, showing a great disrespect for him!"

"Fräulein Cotillard, let me give you some advice," she said sharply. "Herr Reinhardt is a good man. Too trusting for the position he's in. If you abuse the trust he has placed in you, then you will pay a very high price." She pointed a finger at Rose. "I will see to that myself."